RDG-P7 · PRÁCTICA 04

Multiple matching

Hoja 04 · Varias personas sobre un tema · dificultad 4 de 4

10 preguntas (44–53) · 6 secciones (A–F), que pueden repetirse · 1 punto por pregunta · tiempo orientativo: 18 minutos · sin consultar la teoría

You are going to read an article in which six literary translators discuss machine translation. For questions 44–53, choose from the translators (**A–F**). The translators may be chosen more than once. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

Which translator

44 has mixed feelings about being overlooked?

45 admits to having once been secretive about a habit they now acknowledge openly?

46 learned from someone else that their work had deteriorated?

47 concedes the technology's precision while maintaining that it misconceives the task?

48 suspects that a younger generation is more at ease with the technology?

49 acknowledges that evidence has weakened a position they still hold?

50 distinguishes between kinds of material when deciding whether to use the technology?

51 has found that the technology's errors sharpen their own understanding?

52 abandoned a practice they had once championed?

53 supports a concern about earnings with a colleague's experience?

The machine in the room

Six literary translators explain what software has, and has not, changed in their work.

A Hannah Roeder

For about two years I used machine translation without telling anyone, rather as one might take a crib into an exam. I am no longer embarrassed by it, and I say so on every contract. What I use it for is narrow. Novels contain more administrative prose than readers realise: letters from banks, legal notices, the timetable a character reads on a station wall. For that, a machine draft saves me an hour of typing. For dialogue I never use it, because people do not speak in complete sentences and the software insists that they should. Clients sometimes assume that it has made me twice as fast. It has not; checking a fluent draft for its quiet errors takes almost as long as writing one.

B Luis Ferrán

I don't use it, and I don't intend to. My objection is not to the software, which I'll grant is now remarkably accurate sentence by sentence. It is that a novel is not a list of sentences, and a tool that treats it as one has misunderstood the job before it starts. What worries me more is how publishers will use it. A colleague of mine was told last year that her next contract would be for 'post-editing' a machine version, at roughly half her usual rate. The book was a difficult one, and she spent longer correcting the draft than she would have spent translating it from scratch. She took the work anyway. Most of us cannot afford principles for very long.

C **Mei Takahashi**

I treat the machine as a stubborn colleague with no taste. When a sentence resists me, I ask it for three or four versions, not because any of them will be right but because seeing them wrong in different ways shows me what the sentence is actually doing. Its mistakes, in fact, have taught me more than many of the correct answers I have found in dictionaries. I suspect, though, that I use it the way someone of my age uses a smartphone: competently, and without any real fluency. My students move between their own drafts and the machine's with an ease I find rather enviable.

D **Pavel Novák**

I was one of the first in my circle to adopt it, and for a year or so I was its most tiresome advocate. It was fast, it never complained, and I could deliver a draft in half the time. Then a reviewer I respect wrote that my latest translation was 'efficient and oddly airless', and when I reread it I saw what she meant. A year of correcting machine prose had worn my own sentences down to its level: smooth, serviceable and entirely without surprise. I have gone back to working from scratch, with the software switched off. It is slower, and my publisher has noticed. But the reviews have recovered, and so, I think, has my ear.

E **Ruth Adeyemi**

I translate from Yoruba, and the software is still of very little help with literary prose in that language. Its versions of the novels I work on read like a summary by someone who has heard about the book at a party. Part of me is relieved: nobody is going to offer me half my fee to tidy up a machine draft. But it is also a kind of insult. The companies building these tools have poured their effort into the languages that already have plenty of translators and plenty of readers, and the literatures that most need a way into English are the ones they have not bothered with. Being spared the threat is not the same as being taken seriously.

F **Oliver Grant**

I run translation workshops, and my instinct is to keep the machine out of them. Translation is learned through struggle, through sitting with a sentence until you understand why it will not go into English, and a tool that removes the struggle removes the lesson. I should admit, though, that last spring I gave a panel of experienced translators a set of anonymous drafts, half of them produced with machine assistance, and none of us, myself included, could reliably tell which were which. I still believe what I said about struggle. But I can no longer claim that its absence shows on the page, and that, if I am honest, was always the heart of my argument.

Hoja de respuestas

Marca una sola letra por pregunta; la misma letra puede repetirse. Al corregir, 1 punto por acierto; los errores no restan. Anota también el tiempo empleado: el objetivo en el examen son unos 18 minutos.

Nº	A	B	C	D	E	F	Puntos
44	A	B	C	D	E	F	/ 1
45	A	B	C	D	E	F	/ 1
46	A	B	C	D	E	F	/ 1
47	A	B	C	D	E	F	/ 1
48	A	B	C	D	E	F	/ 1
49	A	B	C	D	E	F	/ 1
50	A	B	C	D	E	F	/ 1
51	A	B	C	D	E	F	/ 1
52	A	B	C	D	E	F	/ 1
53	A	B	C	D	E	F	/ 1
						Total	**/ 10**

Tiempo empleado: _____ minutos.

SOLUCIONES

1 punto por acierto. Cada solución da una línea del texto para cada elemento de la pregunta y, cuando hay una sección tentadora, explica por qué falla y de qué tipo es (los tipos de distractor de RDG-P5 §7). Los demás números de sección remiten a RDG-P7_Teoria_v1.

Clave rápida

Nº	Clave	Elementos	Tentadora	Teoría
44	**E**	2	B · medio cierto	§4.1 · §5.1
45	**A**	2	D · medio cierto	§4.1 · §3.4
46	**D**	2	C · medio cierto	§4.1 · §4.2
47	**B**	2	F · medio cierto	§4.1 · §3.4
48	**C**	1	F · no responde	§3.3 · §4.3
49	**F**	2	D · medio cierto	§4.1 · §4.4
50	**A**	1	E · no responde	§3.3 · §4.3
51	**C**	2	D · medio cierto	§4.1 · §3.3
52	**D**	2	A · medio cierto	§4.1 · §3.4
53	**B**	2	E · medio cierto	§4.1 · §5.1

Reparto de claves: A 2 · B 2 · C 2 · D 2 · E 1 · F 1. Cada sección es la respuesta de al menos una pregunta.

Explicación por pregunta

44 · E · Ruth Adeyemi

Pregunta: Which translator has mixed feelings about being overlooked?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. Los dejan de lado: the literatures that most need a way into English are the ones they have not bothered with.
2. Sentimientos encontrados: Part of me is relieved; But it is also a kind of insult.

Tentadora: B (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). También se queda fuera (I don't use it, and I don't intend to), pero por decisión propia y con una sola postura, sin sentimientos encontrados.

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §5.1 Varias personas sobre un tema

45 · A · Hannah Roeder

Pregunta: Which translator admits to having once been secretive about a habit they now acknowledge openly?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. Antes, a escondidas: For about two years I used machine translation without telling anyone.
2. Ahora, abiertamente: I am no longer embarrassed by it, and I say so on every contract.

Tentadora: D (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). Su relación con la herramienta también cambia, pero nunca la ocultó: la defendía en público (for a year or so I was its most tiresome advocate).

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §3.4 Señales de postura y de cambio

46 · D · Pavel Novák

Pregunta: Which translator learned from someone else that their work had deteriorated?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. Lo sabe por otra persona: a reviewer I respect wrote that my latest translation was ‘efficient and oddly airless’.
2. Su trabajo había empeorado: A year of correcting machine prose had worn my own sentences down to its level.

Tentadora: C (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). Reconoce un límite propio (competently, and without any real fluency), pero lo observa ella misma, y no dice que su trabajo haya empeorado.

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §4.2 Lo que se pierde al comprobar

47 · B · Luis Ferrán

Pregunta: Which translator concedes the technology’s precision while maintaining that it misconceives the task?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. Concede la precisión: which I’ll grant is now remarkably accurate sentence by sentence.
2. Pero no entiende la tarea: a novel is not a list of sentences; has misunderstood the job before it starts.

Tentadora: F (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). Reconoce la calidad de los borradores (none of us, myself included, could reliably tell which were which), pero no sostiene que la herramienta entienda mal la tarea: admite que eso debilita su postura.

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §3.4 Señales de postura y de cambio

48 · C · Mei Takahashi

Pregunta: Which translator suspects that a younger generation is more at ease with the technology?

En el texto: I use it the way someone of my age uses a smartphone; My students move between their own drafts and the machine’s with an ease I find rather enviable.

Tentadora: F (no responde, RDG-P5 §7.2). Habla de quienes aprenden (a tool that removes the struggle removes the lesson), pero para temer que la máquina les quite la lección, no para decir que la manejan mejor.

Teoría: §3.3 Prever la paráfrasis · §4.3 La sección tentadora

49 · F · Oliver Grant

Pregunta: Which translator acknowledges that evidence has weakened a position they still hold?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. La prueba: none of us, myself included, could reliably tell which were which.
2. Postura debilitada que mantiene: I still believe what I said about struggle; I can no longer claim that its absence shows on the page.

Tentadora: D (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). Una prueba también le hace cambiar (when I reread it I saw what she meant), pero abandona su postura (I have gone back to working from scratch) en lugar de mantenerla.

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §4.4 Desempatar entre dos secciones

50 · A · Hannah Roeder

Pregunta: Which translator distinguishes between kinds of material when deciding whether to use the technology?

En el texto: letters from banks, legal notices, the timetable a character reads on a station wall frente a For dialogue I never use it.

Tentadora: E (no responde, RDG-P5 §7.2). Distingue, pero entre lenguas (the languages that already have plenty of translators), no entre tipos de texto, y no decide nada sobre su uso.

Teoría: §3.3 Prever la paráfrasis · §4.3 La sección tentadora

51 · C · Mei Takahashi

Pregunta: Which translator has found that the technology's errors sharpen their own understanding?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. Los errores: seeing them wrong in different ways; Its mistakes, in fact, have taught me more.
2. Aclaran su comprensión: shows me what the sentence is actually doing.

Tentadora: D (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). La herramienta también influye en su escritura (had worn my own sentences down to its level), pero empobreciéndola, y no por sus errores, sino por su corrección plana.

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §3.3 Prever la paráfrasis

52 · D · Pavel Novák

Pregunta: Which translator abandoned a practice they had once championed?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. La defendía: I was one of the first in my circle to adopt it; its most tiresome advocate.
2. La abandona: I have gone back to working from scratch, with the software switched off.

Tentadora: A (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). Su relación con la herramienta también cambia, pero en sentido contrario: de usarla a escondidas a usarla abiertamente (I say so on every contract), no a dejarla.

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §3.4 Señales de postura y de cambio

53 · B · Luis Ferrán

Pregunta: Which translator supports a concern about earnings with a colleague's experience?

Elementos (2), cada uno con su línea:

1. Preocupación: What worries me more is how publishers will use it.
2. El caso de una colega: at roughly half her usual rate; she spent longer correcting the draft than she would have spent translating it from scratch.

Tentadora: E (medio cierto, RDG-P5 §7.6). Habla de tarifas (nobody is going to offer me half my fee), pero con alivio, no con preocupación, y sin el caso de ningún colega.

Teoría: §4.1 Preguntas de uno y de dos elementos · §5.1 Varias personas sobre un tema